

# RAFAEL CARBAJAL SANCHEZ

UX / Product Designer | Available June 2027  
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**Portfolio:** [rafaelsanchez.design](https://rafaelsanchez.design)

## SUMMARY

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UX/product designer combining user research, UI design, and AI-assisted coding to build high-fidelity consumer app prototypes. Experience includes Snapchat local services and a deployed AI assistant.

## EDUCATION

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**Santa Monica College** - Santa Monica, CA Expected June 2027  
Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Interaction Design  
Google UX Design Certificate, Coursera 2025

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**Snap Inc. | Snap Design Academy** - Los Angeles, CA Jun - Aug 2026  
**Design Scholar (Contract)**

- Led UX for Resources, a Snapchat local-support concept, partnering with engineering and marketing to take an open prompt to a functional prototype in three weeks.
- Conducted two rounds of partner research and feedback with S.P.Y. and St. Joseph Center; combined findings with usability testing to refine hierarchy, privacy, and service handoffs.
- Created UI components for Resources across Snap Map, Search, Spotlight, and sharing; presented the prototype and design decisions to 300+ Snap employees.

**Plataforma Impact** - Mexico City, Mexico (Remote) Mar 2021 - Jan 2022  
**UX Intern**

- Created website layouts and UI for a B2B specialty coffee brand in Figma and implemented front-end updates, refining the work with senior designers on a remote team.

## SELECTED DESIGN PROJECTS

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**Pantri** | Grocery Planning App Spring 2026

- Used AI-assisted coding to translate Figma designs into a high-fidelity React prototype, implementing the full consumer app journey from onboarding and pantry tracking to meal planning and completion.
- Interviewed 13 grocery shoppers in-store to shape the core flow around budgeting, produce selection, substitutions, and changing shopping routines.
- Prototyped meal-plan micro-interactions and recovery paths for substitutions, quantity changes, and skipped meals, allowing users to adjust the weekly plan without restarting; used simulated data.

**Nibble** | AI Portfolio Assistant Summer 2026

- Launched an AI portfolio assistant with conversational routing and contextual case-study links; handled 250+ visitor questions in its first four weeks.
- Developed context selection and response states to guide visitors to relevant projects; Vercel reporting showed project views per visit rising from 1.6 to 2.3 in the first four weeks after launch.

## VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

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**Blocal** - Los Angeles, CA Aug 2026 - Present  
**UX Designer (Volunteer)** - Designing and building the organization's website.

## SKILLS

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**Design:** End-to-end product design, interaction and UI design, high-fidelity prototyping, UI components, user flows, wireframing, information architecture, accessibility

**Research:** User interviews, usability testing, field research, research synthesis

**Development:** AI-assisted coding (vibe coding), React, JavaScript, HTML/CSS

**Tools:** Figma, Claude Code, Adobe Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign